

WATCH OUT

RIL-VIACOM18-STAR INDIA JV

DISNEY-STAR

STAR INDIA

i) Entertainment

- 1 Star Plus
- 2 Star Bharat
- 3 Star Utsav
- 4 Star Utsav Movies
- 5 Star Gold
- 6 Star Gold 2
- 7 Star Gold Select
- 8 Star Gold Romance
- 9 Star Gold Thrills
- 10 Bindass
- 11 Disney International HD
- 12 Star Movies
- 13 Star Movies Select
- 14 Hungama TV
- 15 Disney Channel
- 16 Disney Junior
- 17 Super Hungama
- 18 National Geographic
- 19 Nat Geo Wild
- 20 Fox Life
- 21 Star Jalsha
- 22 Star Jalsha Movies
- 23 Star Pravah
- 24 Star Pravah Picture
- 25 Star Kiran
- 26 Star Suvarna
- 27 Star Suvarna Plus
- 28 Asianet
- 29 Asianet Plus
- 30 Asianet Movies
- 31 Star Vijay
- 32 Star Vijay Super
- 33 Star Vijay Takkar
- 34 Star Maa
- 35 Star Maa Movies
- 36 Star Maa Music

ii) Sports

- 1 Star Sports 1 Hindi
- 2 Star Sports First
- 3 Star Sports 1
- 4 Star Sports 2
- 5 Star Sports 3
- 6 Star Sports Select 1
- 7 Star Sports Select 2
- 8 Star Sports 1 Kannada
- 9 Star Sports 1 Tamil
- 10 Star Sports 1 Telugu

DIGITAL

- 1 Disney+ Hotstar

VIACOM18

i) Entertainment

- 1 Colors TV
- 2 Colors Rishtey
- 3 Colors Cineplex
- 4 Colors Cineplex Bollywood
- 5 Colors Cineplex Superhits
- 6 MTV
- 7 MTV Beats
- 8 Colors Infinity
- 9 Comedy Central
- 10 VH1
- 11 Nickelodeon
- 12 Nickelodeon Sonic
- 13 Nick Jr.
- 14 Nickelodeon HD+
- 15 History TV18
- 16 Colors Bangla
- 17 Colors Bangla Cinema
- 18 Colors Gujarati
- 19 Colors Gujarati Cinema
- 20 Colors Marathi
- 21 Colors Kannada
- 22 Colors Super
- 23 Colors Kannada Cinema
- 24 Colors Tamil

ii) Sports

- 1 Sports18 1
- 2 Sports18 2
- 3 Sports18 3
- 4 Sports18 Khel

DIGITAL

- 1 JioCinema

NOTE WHEN HD VARIANTS OF CHANNELS ARE CONSIDERED, THEN THE CHANNEL COUNT IS 100; THE JV WILL DIVEST SEVEN CHANNELS

SOURCE COMPANY, ELARA SECURITIES RESEARCH

Look at the money spent buying the media rights to the Indian Premier League (IPL) cricket tournament. In September 2017, Star India acquired the rights for ₹16,348 crore. In 2022, at the next round of bidding, Disney Star, the acquired avatar of Star India, had to pay almost three times that price. A rival broadcaster says that paying so much for the rights places the industry in a difficult position. "In the case of IPL, only the BCCI [Board of Control for Cricket in India] is making money. If less money goes into acquiring the rights, it will return to the system, allowing it to be invested more strategically," says the broadcaster.

Given Reliance-Disney's dominance, will it hike advertising rates? For the 2024 season, IPL cricket fixtures fetched anything from ₹16-19 lakh for a 10-second advertisement spot.

"There is a good chance it will happen, but India is still a highly underleveraged market on a cost per thousand basis," says Sinha of IPG Mediabrands. The advertiser has many options. The rival broadcaster quoted earlier agrees and thinks it could have led to a "monopoly scenario" had most of the money been concentrated on TV.

"There is no doubt Reliance-Disney is a big engine, but advertisers will also look at Google and Facebook. Broadcasters in entertainment and sports will need to look at niches to make themselves more interesting to advertisers," says the broadcaster.

Balu Nayar, former MD of global sports and entertainment company IMG and a key architect of the IPL, says it is rare to see a merger between the No. 1 and 2 players in a market. "The combined Reliance-Disney entity will now be way ahead of the competition in the Indian TV and streaming market. Other transactions like the (proposed) Zee-Sony merger were not at the same level."

Cutting across genres and languages places the entity in a formidable position and way ahead of competition (see accompanying graphic). A higher market share throws up the opportunity to get a higher share of advertising revenue—in regional markets, with smaller advertisers, it always brings in a disproportionate share—and with a bouquet of channels, it helps in controlling the distribution piece as well. In 2018-19, Reliance acquired majority stakes in Hathway Cable and Den Networks to strengthen the distribution component.

In line with the requirements of the Competition Commission of India, Reliance-Disney will divest seven channels: Star Jalsha, Star Jalsha Movies HD (Bengali entertainment), Colors Marathi, Colors Marathi